



The Director's Roundtable

Watch the Director's Roundtable which features multiple prominent directors from acclaimed films. <https://digit.in/may20-41>



Tackling anti-aging

Watch this Netflix interview to learn more about how anti-aging was tackled in The Irishman. <https://digit.in/may20-42>



sions. In a Netflix interview, Pablo Helman spoke about the process of the de-ageing they used. It was important that the process did not interfere with the acting or direction of the film. Test shoots were conducted in order to confirm this. Robert De Niro reenacted a scene from Goodfellas (1990) onto which the effects were then applied. Satisfied with the result, Scorsese decided to take the risk. This, however, meant the need for more financing.

This is where Netflix stepped in. They were ready to financially back this project and take the risk of using the de-ageing technique. Since this was a passion project for Scorsese, he was delighted since it also gave him creative freedom. The trade-off was the fact that it was to be released on a streaming platform and not in theatres. However, after some negotiations, The Irishman got a limited theatrical run opening to only eight cinemas in New York and Los Angeles with other countries such as Australia following suit by releasing it only on some independent chains. as reported by The Guardian, after which it was released on Netflix on November 1, 2019, with a budget of \$159 million.

FILMING

Robert Prieto, the cinematographer, revealed in a GoldDerby interview that towards the end of filming Silence (2016), he heard about the project. Since there was no script ready, he read the book and started visualizing the look and feel of the film. Scorsese and Prieto wanted to go for a vintage look. The filming process involved a 90-day prep and a 108-day shoot. Scorsese and his crew also went through hours of footage and documentaries with regards to the characters to emulate the look. Since the movie goes through different eras of the characters, they decided to make the movie look like memories.

COLOURS

Scorsese wanted it to look like an old home movie but without the grainy, handheld unprofessional feel. Prieto suggested emulating the colour or tint of old photographs that people used to take back in the day. Different eras would use different colour codes. Such as the 1950s would have the Kodachrome look while the 1960s would have the Ektachrome look. With the passage of time, the colour would start to desaturate and look more grey-ish. In the GoldDerby interview, Prieto revealed that colour was reduced gradually since later in Frank's life there is disillusionment and feelings of regret.

CAMERA

With a movie that stars some of the most prolific actors of all time with time shifting back and forth, it was necessary to make the actors look younger. Scenes requiring no visual effects were shot on an ARRICAM LT and ARRICAM ST.



Prieto did not want a modern look for this film. The lenses used were spherical lenses - the Cooke Panchro Classic 75mm and the Zeiss High Speeds with an aspect ratio of 1.85:1 since the main character approached his task in a "methodical" way.

THE THREE-HEADED MONSTER

In order to shoot the scenes involving VFX, a giant contraption of three cameras was used, dubbed the Three-Headed Monster. It consisted

of the RED Helium in the centre and two ARRI Alexa Minis as witness cameras on the sides. Since Scorsese did not want any tracking markers on the actors' faces, the witness cameras were set to capture infrared. These cameras would capture the depth of texture and the infrared markers that were painted onto the actors' faces which would then be used to de-age them in post-production. This would allow the actors to play their characters without the use of any prosthetics, blue tights, tiny golf balls on their faces or subbing in younger actors. Scorsese wanted three camera angles for most scenes. This meant using nine cameras in total for some scenes.

VFX

In a Netflix interview, Pablo Helman and the ILM revealed that they spent about 2 years researching the actors' old movies. ILM downloaded a bunch of their movies and took screen grabs to study the look of each of the actors. Scenes requiring visual effects in The Irishman were a total of 1700 shots and it was necessary to preserve every detail of each of the actors.

One of the primary processes that were involved was the Medusa Facial Capture System. This involved the actors sitting in a chair and going through a series of expressions using which a set of models would be generated which would assist in the blending factor.

The software involved was FLUX; where F stands for facial and LUX is the lighting component. Footage that was shot on set would then be used to analyse the performance and then used to create a 3D model. FLUX allows one to see as to how the light hits an object and capture the textures, shadows or any subtle changes that take place. They also studied many intricate details of the face including wrinkles and pores in order to give the most realistic younger versions of the actors while comparing it to their looks from the older films. 